Debating Club - Term 1

General information

Debating Club is a cocurricular activity open to all students in Years 7-12 who are interested in developing their debating skills. During meetings, students will work with specialist debating coaches to cultivate their skills in persuasive rhetoric, critical thinking, public speaking and collaboration. All students are welcome to join Debating Club, regardless of their debating experience.

In addition to offering Debating Club, Meriden also competes in a number of debating competitions. Trials for these competitions will occur in Term 4 (2026) for Year 7-11 (2026), and beginning of Term 1 for new 2027 enrolments. Students who are selected for these competitions may choose to also participate in Debating Club on Monday afternoons for additional training in debating skills.

Coordinator	Mrs Charlotte Yates, Debating Coordinator, cyates@meriden.nsw.edu.au
All students must commit to:	One session per week Please do not register your daughter if she has prior commitments on a Monday afternoon.
Training Days, Times and Venues	Monday afternoons, 3:30pm to 5pm Meet on The Deck for roll call, then move into allocated classrooms. **Training will commence from Monday 1 February (Week 2, Term 1).**
Transport	N/A
Uniform	School uniform
Cost	$250 per term
Resources required	Students must bring a blank writing book to use in Debating Club each week. They may use the same book over multiple terms. No phones are to be taken into meetings.

Change to activity

Meriden aims to keep any changes to cocurricular activity times and venues to a minimum; however, adjustments may occasionally be necessary due to unforeseen circumstances.

Any cancellation of sessions will be communicated to parents through the Meriden Parent App and eVe.

Attendance

Meriden encourages all girls to be involved in cocurricular programs. Participation in activities requires commitment and positive engagement. Consistent attendance helps students develop technical and soft skills, responsibility, and a sense of belonging within the school community.

Students who are unable to attend a session are expected to notify the activity coordinator with a reason for absence. Students who demonstrate low levels of attendance or engagement may be asked to meet with Mr Richard Hughes, the Dean of Student Involvement, or withdraw from the activity.

Withdrawal

While students are encouraged to commit to cocurricular activities, we understand that sometimes students may choose to withdraw due to changes in school workload, other commitments or to explore new opportunities. If this happens, students should discuss their situation with their parents and the activity coordinator. A withdrawal request should then be sent to the activity coordinator to ensure smooth communication.

A full credit to the student's school account will be made for withdrawals up to Tuesday 8 December. After this date, the fee paid will be forfeited.